Site Analysis Checklist

Analyse the site as a story, not a tick-box exercise. Record it, then synthesise it into a design driver.

Physical & topography

- [ ] Site boundaries and dimensions
- [ ] Levels, slopes and contours
- [ ] Existing trees and features to keep
- [ ] Ground conditions / drainage
- [ ] Existing structures on or near site

Environmental

- [ ] Sun path (summer and winter)
- [ ] Prevailing wind direction
- [ ] Rainfall / exposure
- [ ] Daylight and overshadowing from neighbours
- [ ] Microclimate and shelter

Movement & access

- [ ] Vehicle access and parking
- [ ] Pedestrian routes and desire lines
- [ ] Public transport nearby
- [ ] Service and refuse access
- [ ] Where the entrance wants to be

Context & character

- [ ] Surrounding building heights and scale
- [ ] Materials and local vernacular
- [ ] Key views in and out
- [ ] Landmarks and edges
- [ ] History and identity of the place

Regulatory

- [ ] Planning constraints / conservation area
- [ ] Rights of way and easements
- [ ] Boundary and party wall issues
- [ ] Relevant building regulations

Synthesis

- [ ] Turn the data into 3-4 clear design drivers
- [ ] Draw a synthesis diagram, not just notes

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